

VIA Race III — Ultima Thule

Executive Summary · Netherlands → Norway · ~4,000 km · Race variant

Race Overview

Start	Finish	Participants	Finishers	DNF	DNS
24 Jul 2026	1 Aug 2026	62	32	22	8
Shortest route		Median route		Longest route	Median sleep / rider
3,384 km		3,548 km		4,052 km	82 hrs

Finisher Results

#	Rider	Days	Ride hrs	km/h	Dist km	Elev m
1	Adam Bialek	8.62	162.1	21.5	—	—
2	Bruno Wicht	8.91	171.2	19.8	3,396	37,306
3	Jair Hoogland	9.49	175.1	19.6	—	—
4	Juhani Saario	9.96	175.2	19.5	3,414	35,244
5	Lucas Becker	9.96	160.1	21.9	3,509	34,286
6	Gert Jan Schilder	10.29	187.2	20.0	3,748	36,886
7	James Gill	11.15	178.9	19.4	3,477	37,713
8	Viktor Kovachev	11.42	178.7	20.8	3,713	40,071
9	Krystian Jakubek	11.48	187.1	18.4	3,440	36,702
10	Craig Nilsson	12.28	207.8	17.6	3,657	38,877
11	Anthony ZARRA	12.29	194.1	18.6	3,613	36,899
12	Rafael Ospino	12.67	189.7	18.6	3,521	41,668
13	Mathias Mücke	12.96	187.1	18.1	3,384	38,724
14	Matthew Downie	12.97	169.1	21.3	3,595	35,973
15	Samuel Cibulka	13.52	180.2	19.7	3,545	37,165
16	Gernot Stenz	13.59	232.8	16.1	3,756	39,083
17	Jan-Willem Bobbink	14.02	188.8	18.8	3,552	37,210
18	Bjoern Stiel	14.06	204.3	17.4	3,545	35,587
19	Dr. Philipp Lührs	14.29	175.7	20.0	3,509	34,772
20	Johann Bollen	14.39	196.7	18.1	3,560	35,531
21	Ralph Brune	14.48	182.0	19.3	3,516	33,938
22	Robin Smith	14.63	196.1	18.1	3,542	37,949
23	Brent Olson	15.03	201.3	17.3	3,484	37,948
24	Connie Etter	15.03	203.2	17.0	3,460	40,975
25	Anisa Aubin	15.15	224.2	15.9	3,566	38,612
26	Peter Kuhn	15.34	186.9	19.2	3,580	34,334
27	Laurens Wolting	15.46	195.7	18.1	3,541	40,703
28	Philipp Burgmer	15.59	198.5	18.2	3,621	38,671

#	Rider	Days	Ride hrs	km/h	Dist km	Elev m
29	Sarah Elena Prieto Peña	18.43	215.6	16.8	3,621	42,661
30	CÉSAR OBESO DÍEZ	18.43	223.2	16.3	3,647	39,768
31	Jason Vail	19.52	222.8	16.1	3,582	42,325
32	Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	20.51	206.4	19.6	4,052	46,521

Days = gate-to-gate elapsed time. Ride hrs = time above 2 km/h. km/h = avg moving speed. Dist km = odometer clipped to race window. Three riders are confirmed as official finishers by race organisers via override.

Route Highlights

Rider	Rank	Route	Note
Juhani Saario	#4	3,414 km	134 km shorter than field median (3,548 km). Matched #5 Lucas Becker's finish time within 2 min
Mathias Mücke	#13	3,384 km	Shortest route among all finishers — 30 km less than Juhani Saario.
Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	#32	4,052 km	Longest route by 504 km above median, accumulating strategic loops to collect gates via Strynefjell and

Fastest Segment Spotlights

Leg	Character	Fastest rider	Best km/h	Median km/h
Sognefjellet → Lom	~1,400 m descent off the highest road in Norway	Matthew Downie	38.7	29.6
Lysebotn → Botn	Long valley exit from Lysefjord	Matthew Downie	25.3	18.3
Botn → Vøringfossen	Fjord valley climb to Hardanger plateau	Matthew Downie	24.6	18.7
Brocken → Fredriksten	Germany–Denmark–Norway push through Scandinavia	Bruno Wicht	28.3	23.8
Suleskard → Lysebotn	High-alpine traverse to fjord bottom	Robin Smith	21.6	17.1

■ On Suleskard → Lysebotn, Robin Smith recorded the highest moving speed (21.6 km/h) but Bruno Wicht completed the leg fastest overall (2.4 hrs) with fewer stops.

Matthew Downie — fastest on 4 of 11 common legs: Lysebotn → Botn (25.3 km/h), Sognefjellet → Lom (38.7 km/h), Botn → Vøringfossen (24.6 km/h), Urnes → Gaularfjellet (22.4 km/h). He finished #14 overall, demonstrating exceptional segment pace across the full breadth of the route.

Gate-to-Gate Segment Analysis — All Common Legs

Legs shared by ≥ 20 of the 32 finishers. Avg moving speed excludes time below 2 km/h. ★ = Matthew Downie fastest.

Leg	Riders	Median km/h	Fastest rider	Best km/h
Brocken → Fredriksten	32	23.8	Bruno Wicht	28.3
Suleskard → Lysebotn	32	17.1	Robin Smith	21.6
★ Lysebotn → Botn	29	18.3	Matthew Downie	25.3
Vøringfossen → Borgund	23	22.3	Jan-Willem Bobbink	26.5
★ Sognefjellet → Lom	27	29.6	Matthew Downie	38.7
Svøufallet → Atlantic Rd	30	21.9	Juhani Saario	25.1
Vestkapp → Volda	28	20.6	Dr. Philipp Lührs	23.8
★ Botn → Vøringfossen	28	18.7	Matthew Downie	24.6
Fredriksten → Suleskard	29	18.7	Bruno Wicht	23.1
Start → Brocken	32	25.6	Lucas Becker	29.1
★ Urnes → Gaularfjellet	21	19.1	Matthew Downie	22.4

Yellow rows = legs where fastest rider beat field median by ≥ 8 km/h.

Sleep & Rest Patterns

Rest detected as GPS speed < 3 km/h sustained ≥ 45 min within the race window. Rest % = (elapsed – ride time) / elapsed.

#	Rider	Sleep hrs	Stops	Rest %	Ride hrs	Days
1	Adam Bialek	0.0	0	22%	162.1	8.62
2	Bruno Wicht	20.8	4	20%	171.2	8.91
3	Jair Hoogland	0.0	0	23%	175.1	9.49
4	Juhani Saario	31.2	9	27%	175.2	9.96
5	Lucas Becker	49.5	12	33%	160.1	9.96
6	Gert Jan Schilder	27.7	7	24%	187.2	10.29
7	James Gill	55.0	10	33%	178.9	11.15
8	Viktor Kovachev	67.4	11	35%	178.7	11.42
9	Krystian Jakubek	52.3	17	32%	187.1	11.48
10	Craig Nilsson	38.4	14	29%	207.8	12.28
11	Anthony ZARRA	71.0	12	34%	194.1	12.29
12	Rafael Ospino	77.5	21	38%	189.7	12.67
13	Mathias Mücke	90.2	19	40%	187.1	12.96
14	Matthew Downie	92.6	20	46%	169.1	12.97
15	Samuel Cibilka	104.5	20	44%	180.2	13.52
16	Gernot Stenz	41.1	11	29%	232.8	13.59
17	Jan-Willem Bobbink	77.0	12	44%	188.8	14.02
18	Bjoern Stiel	72.5	18	39%	204.3	14.06
19	Dr. Philipp Lühns	101.4	23	49%	175.7	14.29
20	Johann Bollen	93.1	20	43%	196.7	14.39
21	Ralph Brune	104.3	16	48%	182.0	14.48
22	Robin Smith	108.2	13	44%	196.1	14.63
23	Brent Olson	93.9	22	44%	201.3	15.03
24	Connie Etter	85.9	23	44%	203.2	15.03
25	Anisa Aubin	73.0	20	38%	224.2	15.15
26	Peter Kuhn	115.8	19	49%	186.9	15.34
27	Laurens Wolting	124.5	22	47%	195.7	15.46
28	Philipp Burgmer	151.3	17	47%	198.5	15.59
29	Sarah Elena Prieto Peña	156.1	37	51%	215.6	18.43
30	CÉSAR OBESO DÍEZ	173.4	40	50%	223.2	18.43
31	Jason Vail	173.4	48	52%	222.8	19.52
32	Enrico Halix & Malte Weise	180.3	32	58%	206.4	20.51

Red Rest % = ≥ 50% of elapsed time not moving. Green rows = top 3 finishers.

Notes

- Race distance is odometer clipped to the start–finish gate window, not raw tracker odometer. Raw odo inflates distance for riders whose trackers kept logging after finishing; four riders had their raw odometer corrected as a result.
- Gate detection radius: 1,000 m (haversine). 500 m produced false negatives on legitimately-ridden gates.

- Three riders are confirmed as official finishers by race organisers via override; their finish times and some metrics are set from official results.
- GPS data exported 2026-09-02. All analysis uses Race variant only (62 of 104 entrants).